

DANIEL OKAFOR

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with nine years of experience designing and running high-volume services on the JVM. Comfortable owning a service end to end, from API design and data modelling to on-call. Currently building payment processing systems in Berlin.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer - Kestrel Payments GmbH, Berlin 01/2023 - present

- Lead engineer for the settlement service (Kotlin, Spring Boot, PostgreSQL), ~2 M transactions per day
- Introduced event-driven reconciliation with Kafka, cutting manual corrections by 70 %
- Mentoring three engineers; driving API design reviews and the team's on-call rota

Backend Engineer - Harbourline Logistics Ltd, London 06/2019 - 12/2022

- Built the shipment tracking API in Java 11 / Spring Boot serving 40 partner integrations
- Migrated batch jobs from cron scripts to a queue-based design on AWS SQS
- Reduced p95 latency of the booking endpoint from 900 ms to 180 ms through query tuning and caching (Redis)

Software Developer - Brightwater Systems Ltd, Leeds 09/2016 - 05/2019

- Maintained a Java EE billing platform for regional water utilities
- Wrote integration tests with JUnit and Testcontainers; raised coverage from 35 % to 75 %

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science, University of Leeds 2013 - 2016

SKILLS

Java, Kotlin, Spring Boot, PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka, AWS (ECS, SQS, RDS), Docker, Terraform (basic), REST, gRPC, JUnit, Testcontainers, Grafana, Prometheus

LANGUAGES

English (native) · German (B1) · Igbo (conversational)